



ACTION FOR REFUGEE LIFE

Monitoring & Evaluation Unit

Project Brief

Cohort 7 Planning and Improvement

Prepared for: Data Science and Machine Learning Trainees, Cohort 6

Prepared by: AReL Monitoring & Evaluation Unit

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Background

AReL has now run six cohorts across nine courses since 2023. Over that time the program has grown, courses have evolved, and record keeping has improved in some places and lagged in others. What has not existed until now is a single place where enrolment outcomes and day to day attendance sit together, ready to be queried.

Cohort 7 is being planned. Before it is finalised, the M&E Unit wants to understand what the last five cohorts actually show about where students engage well, where they fall away, and whether anything about how a course was run, who taught it, or when its sessions fell made a measurable difference.

The Ask

The M&E Unit is approaching you as data analysts, not as students completing an exercise. You have been given the program's enrolment and attendance data. Your task is to analyse it and produce findings that can genuinely inform how Cohort 7 is planned and run.

There is no fixed list of questions to answer. Part of the work is deciding what is worth asking. Some starting points that matter to the program:

- Where in a course do students tend to disengage, and does that timing repeat across cohorts?
- Is there a relationship between early attendance and whether a student completes?
- Did the change to a five day week in Cohort 6 affect attendance compared to the three day schedule used before it?
- Do certain days of the week consistently see weaker attendance, and does that hold across courses?
- Where an instructor changed partway through a course, did anything shift afterward?
- Which courses or cohorts show patterns worth acting on before Cohort 7 begins?

What You Have Been Given

Seven linked tables, covering Cohorts 1 through 6. Cohort 1 ran a single course and is thin by comparison, so most of the signal sits in Cohorts 2 through 6.

Table	Size	What it holds
cohorts	6 rows	Cohort ID, label, start/end date, weekly schedule
courses	9 rows	Course ID, name, category, status, predecessor course
instructors	10 rows	Instructor ID and name
instructor_assignments	25 rows	Which instructor taught which course and cohort, and when
students	260 rows	Student ID, name, gender, email, phone
enrolments	565 rows	Student x course x cohort, status, dropout reason, employment status
attendance	58,944 rows	One row per student per scheduled class session

The tables are normalised. A student's name lives in one place, a course's name lives in one place, and everything else connects to those by ID. Expect to join across several tables to answer most of the questions above.

A Note on the Data

This data was not cleaned up before being handed to you, and it should not be. A meaningful share of enrolment records carry a status of Unknown, because rosters for some cohorts were never fully updated after the cohort ended. Student contact details are missing in most records. A small number of class sessions across every cohort have no attendance recorded at all.

None of this is a mistake in the dataset. It reflects how the program's records actually look, and deciding how to handle it, rather than ignoring it or guessing, is part of the analysis.

What to Deliver

A short written report, addressed to the M&E Unit, that presents what you found and what you recommend for Cohort 7. Back every recommendation with a specific query result, not an impression. Include the SQL behind your key findings so the work can be checked and reused.

Timeline

To be confirmed with your instructor. Work through the questions at a pace that allows for genuine exploration rather than rushing to a predetermined answer.